Key Messages

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- From October 2022 to January 2023, the food security conditions of poor households in rural and urban areas are expected to seasonally improve due to the output of the harvests, a slight drop in food prices, and a seasonal increase in income. From February to May 2023, the lean season, which will start early for households most affected by crop loss, will result in a seasonal deterioration of the food situation of urban and rural households, accentuated by the ongoing high inflation rates in all three countries. This will be reflected in the gradual rise in households facing Stressed (IPC Phase 2) and Crisis (IPC Phase 3) outcomes in all three countries, as the outlook period unfolds, with no changes in area classification.

- Following the *primera* harvest, food availability will further improve with the *postrera* harvest in November. The *postrera* harvest will have near average production, despite some post-harvest losses due to excess moisture, and damages from Hurricane Julia. Nonetheless, subsistence households will have lower harvests due to reduced sowing areas and the damages caused by Hurricane Julia. The weather forecast will favor the production of the *apante*/late *postrera* season in areas of Honduras and Nicaragua, allowing red bean supplies to flow to national and regional markets. It will also favor the beginning of the 2023 *primera* season, but with smaller than usual sowing areas given above-average agricultural input prices.

- By the beginning of the season, the impact of high prices will be mitigated until February/March, high labor demand is expected, as well as a seasonal increased in urban commercial activities. However, even as staple grain prices decline with the arrive of harvests, the persistence of high inflation will continue to limit the purchasing power of households throughout the analysis period.

AREA	CURRENT ANOMALIES	PROJECTED ANOMALIES
Regional	Despite being stable compared to the previous month, and there being a slight drop concerning previous months, the rise in general and food inflation persisted in September, with	Although the sharp rise in international fuel prices has subsided, they are expected to remain above average until May 2023, reflected in higher food prices and general inflation throughout the